Training vs. Inference

Learning parameters versus using them

SCAN / LEARN

THE MAIN IDEA

Training adjusts model parameters using examples and feedback. Inference uses the resulting parameters to answer a new request.

FOLLOW THE SYSTEM

01

EXAMPLES

A training process sees many examples.

02

LEARNING

An optimizer adjusts parameter values.

03

SAVED MODEL

The trained values are stored as a model.

04

NEW QUESTION

Inference computes an answer without generally retraining.

EXAMPLES → TRAINING → PARAMETERS → INFERENCE

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

Every message permanently teaches the base model a new fact.

MORE ACCURATE

A conversation can change context or stored memory; this is not the same as model training.

THREE QUESTIONS TO KEEP

PROBLEM: How can a model improve before it is used?

FAILURE: Poor training data leads to weak generalization.

IN REAL LIFE: Model building, updates, production answers.

SOLO DISCOVERY

Try alone: imagine studying for a test (training), then answering unseen questions (inference).